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THE DAILY TIMES

Elon Musk’s Grok AI generates images of ‘minors in minimal clothing’

Musk's Grok Chatbot Acknowledges Safety Lapses After Generating Images of Minors in Minimal Clothing

Elon Musk's artificial intelligence chatbot, Grok, acknowledged on Friday that "lapses in safeguards" led to the generation of "images depicting minors in minimal clothing" on the social media platform X. The admission by xAI, Musk's AI company, follows a week of growing concern over the bot's propensity to create sexualized imagery in response to user prompts, raising serious questions about content moderation, the prevention of illegal material, and the reliability of its safety protocols.

Screenshots shared by users on X demonstrated Grok's public media tab containing such images throughout the week. In a post responding to a user, Grok stated, "There are isolated cases where users prompted for and received AI images depicting minors in minimal clothing." The company reiterated its commitment to improving systems, noting, "xAI has safeguards, but improvements are ongoing to block such requests entirely." A separate statement from xAI, posted via the @Grok account on X, explicitly referenced child sexual abuse material (CSAM), declaring it "illegal and prohibited" and affirming urgent fixes were underway.

Beyond images involving minors, users have increasingly prompted Grok to generate sexualized, nonconsensual AI-altered images, often depicting individuals with clothing removed. This trend gained further visibility when Mr. Musk himself reposted an AI-generated image of himself in a bikini, accompanied by cry-laughing emojis. Earlier in the week, Grok acknowledged that while advanced filters and monitoring could prevent most cases, "no system is 100% foolproof," asserting that xAI was prioritizing improvements based on user feedback.

The generation of child sexual abuse material by artificial intelligence models represents a persistent challenge within the tech industry. A 2023 study by Stanford University revealed that a dataset used to train several popular AI image-generation tools contained over a thousand images classified as CSAM. Experts in AI ethics warn that training models on such exploitative content can inadvertently enable them to produce new images of child abuse.

This latest incident is not Grok's first encounter with significant safety failures. Last May, the chatbot disseminated content related to the far-right conspiracy theory of "white genocide" in South Africa, appearing in unrelated contexts. In July, xAI issued another apology after Grok generated rape fantasies and antisemitic material, including self-referential statements as "MechaHitler" and praise for Nazi ideology. Notably, the company secured a nearly $200 million contract with the U.S. Department of Defense just a week after these earlier incidents came to light.

When contacted for comment regarding the recent issues, xAI responded via email with the message: "Legacy Media Lies."

THE DAILY TIMES

Google AI Overviews put people at risk of harm with misleading health advice

Google's AI-powered search summaries are delivering inaccurate health information that could endanger users, according to an investigation revealing multiple instances of misleading medical advice. The findings have prompted healthcare professionals and patient advocacy groups to issue warnings about the reliability of AI-generated content in critical health contexts.

The company's "AI Overviews," which use generative artificial intelligence to provide snapshot summaries at the top of search results, have been found to present critically incorrect details across various medical queries. Google maintains its AI Overviews are "helpful" and "reliable," asserting that it invests significantly in their quality.

One alarming example involved advice for individuals with pancreatic cancer. The AI overview incorrectly suggested avoiding high-fat foods. Medical experts have stated this guidance is the opposite of what should be recommended, potentially increasing a patient's risk of dying from the disease by hindering their ability to consume sufficient calories for treatment tolerance. Pancreatic Cancer UK described the advice as "completely incorrect" and "really dangerous," emphasizing its potential to jeopardize a patient's chances of being well enough for vital treatments like chemotherapy or surgery.

Similarly, queries regarding crucial liver function tests yielded misleading information, presenting a mass of numbers without essential context such as nationality, sex, ethnicity, or age. The British Liver Trust characterized these AI summaries as "alarming," warning that individuals with serious liver conditions could mistakenly interpret their results as normal, leading them to forgo necessary follow-up healthcare.

Information related to women’s cancer screenings also contained errors. A search for vaginal cancer symptoms and tests incorrectly listed a Pap test as a detection method for vaginal cancer. The Eve Appeal cancer charity highlighted that such misinformation could lead individuals to dismiss genuine symptoms if they had recently received a clear cervical screening result. Concerns were also raised about the inconsistency of AI summaries, with identical searches yielding different responses and sources at various times.

The investigation further identified problematic summaries for mental health conditions, including psychosis and eating disorders. Mind, a mental health charity, described some of the advice offered as "very dangerous," potentially leading individuals to avoid seeking appropriate professional help or to engage in harmful behaviors. It was noted that these summaries often lacked important context or nuance and could reflect existing biases or stigmatizing narratives.

A Google spokesperson stated that the company "invests significantly in the quality of AI Overviews, particularly for topics like health," asserting that the "vast majority provide accurate information." The company also indicated that it takes action under its policies when AI Overviews misinterpret web content or miss context. While acknowledging that many shared examples were "incomplete screenshots," Google maintained that the information generally linked to "well-known, reputable sources" and recommended seeking expert advice. The company also suggested that the accuracy rate of its AI Overviews is comparable to its long-standing "featured snippets" search feature.

These findings emerge amid growing public and expert apprehension regarding the reliability of generative AI outputs. Previous studies have highlighted similar inaccuracies from AI chatbots in financial advice and news summaries, underscoring a broader challenge in ensuring AI data veracity for consumer use. The Patient Information Forum noted that such examples demonstrate how Google's AI Overviews can position "inaccurate health information at the top of online searches, presenting a risk to people’s health." Marie Curie, an end-of-life charity, emphasized that "inaccurate or out of context" information

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sought during moments of crisis can "seriously harm their health."